

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff in B-flat major (two flats). The key signature is B-flat major. The time signature is irregular, changing from 2/2 to 3/2 and back to 2/2. The score is divided into three systems. Each system includes guitar chords and fingerings. The first system starts with a 2/2 time signature and ends with a 2/2 time signature. The second system starts with a 3/2 time signature and ends with a 2/2 time signature. The third system starts with a 2/2 time signature and ends with a 2/2 time signature. The lyrics are: 'As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way, and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way. 1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down. Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray. The score ends with a 'D.C.' (Da Capo) instruction.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...